

SENATE No. 2711

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

SENATE, November 13, 2025.

The committee on Senate Rules to whom was referred the Senate Bill relative to the commission on LGBTQ aging (Senate, No. 473, changed) reports, that the matter be placed in the Orders of the Day for Thursday, November 13, 2025, with an amendment substituting a new draft entitled "An Act relative to the commission on LGBTQ aging" (Senate, No. 2711).

For the committee,
Joan B. Lovely

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An Act relative to the commission on LGBTQ aging.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

Section 71 of chapter 3 of the General Laws is hereby amended by striking out subsections (a) and (b), as appearing in the 2024 Official Edition, and inserting in place thereof the following 2 subsections:-

(a) There shall be a permanent commission on older lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, queer and questioning, or LGBTQ, adults and their caregivers to consist of the following members or their designees: the chairs of the joint committee on aging and independence who shall serve as co-chairs; 1 person to be appointed by the senate president; 1 person to be appointed by the speaker of the house of representatives; 1 person to be appointed by the minority leader of the senate; 1 person to be appointed by the minority leader of the house of representatives; the secretary of aging and independence; the secretary of housing and livable communities; the commissioner of public health; the director of the LGBTQIA+ Aging Project; the president of Fenway Community Health Center, Inc.; the executive director of the GLBTQ Legal Advocates & Defenders, Inc.; a representative of the New England Association on HIV Over Fifty, Inc.; the executive director of MassEquality; the executive director of Massachusetts

15 Aging Access Association, Inc.; the director of AARP Massachusetts; the executive director of
16 the Massachusetts Association of Councils on Aging, Inc.; the director of the Massachusetts
17 Senior Care Association, Inc.; the director of Home Care Aide Council; and 5 members to be
18 appointed by the governor, 1 of whom shall be an attorney licensed to practice in the
19 commonwealth who practices elder law, 1 of whom shall be an expert in LGBTQ public policy
20 or research and 3 older LGBTQ adults, at least 1 of whom shall be transgender. The governor's
21 appointees shall ensure that the commission has at least 1 representative from each of the
22 following regions of the commonwealth: Cape Cod, western Massachusetts and central
23 Massachusetts.

24 (b) The commission shall investigate, analyze and study the health, housing, financial,
25 psychosocial and long-term care needs of older LGBTQ adults and their caregivers and shall
26 make recommendations to improve access to benefits and services where appropriate and
27 necessary. The commission shall: (i) examine the impact of the commonwealth's policies and
28 regulations on older LGBTQ adults and make recommendations to ensure equality of access,
29 treatment, care and benefits; (ii) examine strategies to increase provider awareness of the needs
30 of older LGBTQ adults and their caregivers and improve the competence of and access to
31 treatment, services and ongoing care, including preventive care; (iii) assess the funding and
32 programming needed to enhance services to the growing population of older LGBTQ adults; (iv)
33 examine best practices for increasing access, reducing isolation, preventing abuse and
34 exploitation, promoting independence and self-determination, strengthening caregiving,
35 eliminating disparities and improving quality of life; (v) examine whether certain policies and
36 practices, or the absence of certain policies and practice, promote the premature admission of
37 older LGBTQ adults to institutional care; (vi) recommend, as appropriate and necessary, lower

38 cost and culturally appropriate home and community-based alternatives to institutional care; (vii)
39 examine the feasibility of developing statewide training curricula to improve provider
40 competency in the delivery of health, housing and long-term support services to older LGBTQ
41 adults and their caregivers; and (viii) examine outreach protocols to reduce apprehension among
42 older LGBTQ adults and their caregivers of utilizing mainstream providers.